



Marielena Soilemezidi

PhD Candidate at NKUA &
NLU Engineer at Omilia

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Marielena Soilemezidi

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Interests

- Psycholinguistics
- Natural Language Processing
- Computational Linguistics
- Data Science

Skills

Programming:

R

Python

MATLAB

Version Control Tools:

Git & GitHub

Research Tools:

PsychoPy

ELAN

SPSS

ExperimentBuilder

Praat

Research Methods:

Eye-Tracking

EEG

fMRI

Education

Postgraduate Studies

2019 – 2026
(ongoing)

Ph.D. in Neurolinguistics
Title: Morphosyntactic production and processing in agrammatic aphasia.
Supervisors: prof. Spyridoula Varlokosta, prof. Valantis Fyndanis, prof. Athanasios Protopapas.

NKUA, GR

2017 – 2018

M.Sc. in Cognitive Neuroscience of Language
MA Thesis: Time processing during sentence comprehension: an eye-tracking study.
Supervisors: Dr. Simona Mancini & Dr. Nicoletta Biondo
Grade: 8.8/10

UPV & BCBL, ES

Aphasia

Morphosyntax

Language Disorders

Cognition

Neuroscience

Cognition

Research Methods

Bilingualism

Undergraduate Study

2012 – 2016

B.A. in Philology (specialization: Linguistics)
BA Thesis: The acquisition of verbs with non-active morphology in Greek as a native language: the case of reflexive verbs.
Supervisors: prof. Spyridoula Varlokosta
Grade: 10/10

NKUA, GR

Jan – Jun, 2015

Erasmus Exchange
Courses: Sociolinguistics, Grammar, Swedish courses.

LU, SE

Other Training

4-10 Sept, 2025

Athens Natural Language Processing Summer School (AthNLP2025) GR
organized by RC “Athena”, NCSR “Demokritos”, Athens University of Economics and Business (Informatics), and Heriot-Watt University.

19-25 Sept, 2024

Athens Natural Language Processing Summer School (AthNLP2024) GR
organized by RC “Athena”, NCSR “Demokritos”, Athens University of Economics and Business (Informatics), and Heriot-Watt University.

Jan, 2023

General course in meta-analysis and systematic review UiO, NO
Topics covered: literature searches, coding protocols, data extraction, and data coding, statistical analyses and reporting of meta-analyses; validity of meta-analysis

12-15 Sept, 2022

6th Summer School for Statistical Methods for Linguistics and Psychology (SMLP2022) UP, DE
“Fundamentals of Frequentist Statistics” stream: simulations to compute power, multiple regressions, interpretations of mixed models

30 May – 2 Jun, 2022

LITHME – 2nd Training School U.PORTO, PT
Language In the Human Machine Era. Member of working groups: computational linguistics & language learning and teaching

9-13 May, 2022

Eye tracking: methods for psychological and educational research UiO, NO
Lectures and hands-on lab experience covering all parts of an ET experiment (from ET experiment design to data analysis)

2021 – 2023

CIVIS courses for PhD students SU, SE
- Open Science (5 ECTS) – 2021
- Methods for Handling Text Data (7,5 ECTS) – 2023

Research Experience

Mar, 2020 – Dec, 2024

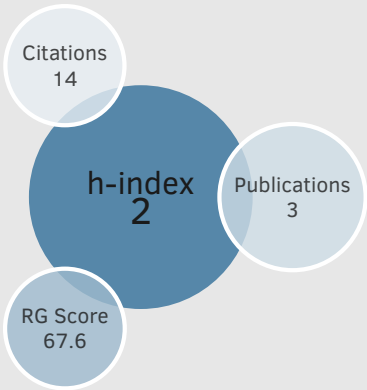
Research Assistant
Experience in: a) data analysis (including data inspection, data cleaning and pre-processing, and visualizations) using R (statistical methods: generalized linear models); b) data collection for linguistic and psychological experiments (on-line/off-line); c) experiment design (e.g., building up experimental stimuli, questionnaires)

UiO, NO

Short Bio

Marielena is a firm believer in Open Science and FAIR data principles. A devotee of life-long learning, she is always seeking out opportunities to deepen her ever-growing computational and analytic interests. She is passionate about Natural Language Processing and Data Science, and enjoys building systems that make human-machine interaction smarter.

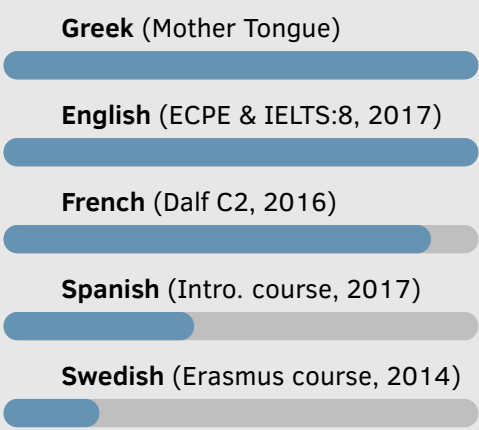
Metrics



Profiles



Languages



Personal

In her spare time, Marielena enjoys exercising (running, swimming, pilates), **reading and reviewing books, sketching**, playing the piano (poorly) and DnD and other board games (much more efficiently) with her friends. She is a member of the volunteering group **“Reading to the Others”** since 2017, enhancing access of blind and visually impaired people to printed text by narrating audiobooks.

Work Experience

Jul, 2025 – today	NLU Engineer Designing, developing, and optimizing NLU components for conversational AI systems	Omilia
Mar – Jun, 2025	Junior Data Scientist Contributing to: a) pipelines for data cleaning and analysis using Python; b) AI-related projects (e.g., conversational AI agent, automarking tool for essays)	PeopleCert
Dec, 2024 – Feb, 2025	Industry Research Assistant Worked on: a) data handling (data inspection, cleaning, and pre-processing) and data-analysis using R; b) analyses reports; c) administrative duties (e.g., website updates, meeting minutes)	PeopleCert

Teaching Experience

Academic Teaching and Supervision

2021 – 2022	BA Thesis Co-Supervisor Academic support (resources, guidance, feedback on theoretical chapters) and technical training (aphasic speech annotation) for the BA thesis titled “Narrative Analysis of Aphasic Speech in Greek”; main BA thesis supervisor: prof. S. Varlokosta	NKUA, GR
Nov, 2021	Guest Instructor Lecture on Neuroimaging Techniques used for language studies to BA students for the course “Psycholinguistics – Neurolinguistics” (Fall semester, 2021; instructor: Dr. E. Kyritsi)	NKUA, GR

Secondary Education

Dec, 2023 – Jun, 2024	Secondary Education Instructor Greek Language Teaching as Second Language (integration class)	4th Public High School of Athens, GR
Nov, 2018 – Jul, 2020	Secondary Education Instructor Modern Greek Language Teaching to students 12 to 17, with diverse learning needs and cultural backgrounds	Alimpinisis (Private Tutoring School), GR

Honours and Awards

2021 – 2024	Scholarship for doctoral studies (3rd Call for PhD Students by the Hellenic Foundation of Research & Innovation)	H.F.R.I., GR
2019 – 2020	Scholarship for doctoral studies	A. G. Leventis Foundation, GR
2017 – 2018	Tuition fee scholarship for the MA in Cognitive Neuroscience of Language by the Basque Center on Cognition, Brain and Language due to excellent undergraduate performance	BCBL, ES
2012 – 2016	Scholarship for undergraduate studies (National and Kapodistrian University of Athens; legacy of Antonios Papadakis)	NKUA, GR
2008	Honorary distinction from the Hellenic Mathematical Society for participating in the 68th contest in Mathematics	HMS, GR

Digital Competence

2023	Carpentries Instructor Qualified to teach Data/Library/Software Carpentry. Completed the Carpentries Instructor Training program, and a teaching demonstration for Data Carpentry	Carpentries
2021 – 2025	Member of the Organizing Committee of ‘Athens PyLadies’ Main goal of the group is the creation of a community that will facilitate access to programming, primarily for individuals with a background in the Humanities.	PyLadies

Publications

Journals

- Fyndanis, V., Burgio, F., Buivolova, O., Danesin, L., Gardner, Q., Kalpakidi, T., Scimeca, M., **Soilemezidi, M.**, Kiran, S., & Dragoy, O. (2025). Teasing apart time reference-related encoding and retrieval deficits in aphasia: Evidence from Greek, Russian, Italian and English. *Aphasiology*, 39(9), 1242–1276. <https://doi.org/10.1080/02687038.2024.2415927>
- **Soilemezidi, M.**, Kubota, M., Chrisikopoulou, M., & Fyndanis, V. (2024). Independent effects of age, education, verbal working memory, motor speed of processing, locality and morphosyntactic category on verb-related morphosyntactic production: Evidence from healthy aging. *Topics in Cognitive Science*, 00, 1–38. <https://doi.org/10.1111/tops.12750>
- Biondo, N., **Soilemezidi, M.**, & Mancini, S. (2021). Yesterday is history, tomorrow is a mystery: An eye-tracking investigation of the processing of past and future time reference during sentence reading. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition*, 48(7), 1001–1018. <https://doi.org/10.1037/xlm0001053>

Conferences

Oral Presentations

- **Soilemezidi, M.**, & Fyndanis, V. "The role of cognitive functions and education in verb-related morphosyntactic production". *42nd Annual Meeting of the Department of Linguistics of the Aristotle University of Thessaloniki (AMLG42)*. May 2022, online conference.
- Fyndanis, V., **Soilemezidi, M.**, & Kalpakidi, T. "Impaired production of time reference in Greek aphasia: Disentangling encoding from retrieval deficits". *42nd Annual Meeting of the Department of Linguistics of the Aristotle University of Thessaloniki (AMLG42)*. May 2022, online conference.

Posters

- **Soilemezidi, M.**, Varlokosta, S., Kalpakidi, T., & Fyndanis, V. "Time reference and aspect in Greek: evidence from stroke-induced aphasia and healthy aging." Poster presented at the *Science of Aphasia conference*. September 2024, Geneva.
- **Soilemezidi, M.**, Kubota, M., Chrisikopoulou, M., & Fyndanis, V. "Independent effects of age, education, verbal working memory, motor speed of processing, locality and morphosyntactic category on verb-related morphosyntactic production: Evidence from healthy aging." Poster presented at the *20th International Workshop on Language Production*. June 2024, Marseille.
- Fyndanis, V., Buivolova, O., **Soilemezidi, M.**, Kalpakidi, T., Varlokosta, S., & Dragoy, O. "Time reference and aspect in Greek and Russian stroke-induced aphasia". Poster presented at the *Academy of Aphasia 61st Annual Meeting*. September 2023, Reading/Hybrid.
- **Soilemezidi, M.**, Chrisikopoulou, M., & Fyndanis, V. "Independent effects of age, education, verbal working memory, locality and morphosyntactic category on verb-related morphosyntactic production: Evidence from healthy aging". Poster presented at the *Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing conference (AMLaP)*. September 2023, San Sebastián.
- Fyndanis, V., Buivolova, O., **Soilemezidi, M.**, Kalpakidi, T., & Dragoy, O. "Teasing apart tense-related encoding and retrieval deficits in aphasia". Poster presented at the *Academy of Aphasia 60th Annual Meeting*. October 2022, Philadelphia/Hybrid.
- **Soilemezidi, M.**, Chrisikopoulou, M., & Fyndanis, V. "The role of cognitive functions, demographic factors, and locality in verb-related morphosyntactic production". Poster presented at the *Science of Aphasia conference*. September 2022, Bordeaux.
- Fyndanis, V., **Soilemezidi, M.**, & Kalpakidi, T. "Impaired production of time reference in aphasia: Disentangling encoding from retrieval deficits". Poster presented at the *Science of Aphasia conference*. September 2022, Bordeaux.
- Biondo, N., **Soilemezidi, M.**, & Mancini, S. "Time in language: past and future are differently processed and both verbs and adverbs matter". Poster presented at the *12th Annual Meeting of the Society for the Neurobiology of Language*. October 2020, online conference.

Other

- **Soilemezidi, M.**, Gardner, Q., Antfolk, J., Varlokosta, S., Goral, M., Longva, J., Töredi, D., & Fyndanis, V. (2026). *Production and comprehension of past and future reference in agrammatic aphasia: A systematic review and meta-analysis*. PsyArXiv. https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/renq6_v1
- **Soilemezidi, M.**, Gardner, Q., Varlokosta, S., Longva, J., & Fyndanis, V. (2022). "NIRO SR: Preregistration protocol for the Meta-Analysis project 'Production and Comprehension of Past and Future Reference in Agrammatic Aphasia: A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis'". Available at: <https://osf.io/axjgy/>
- **Soilemezidi, M.**, & Fyndanis, V. (2021). Translation – Adaptation to Greek of the *Language Experience and Proficiency Questionnaire (LEAP-Q)*, by Marian, Blumenfeld, & Kaushanskaya (2007). Available at: <https://bilingualism.northwestern.edu/leapq/>